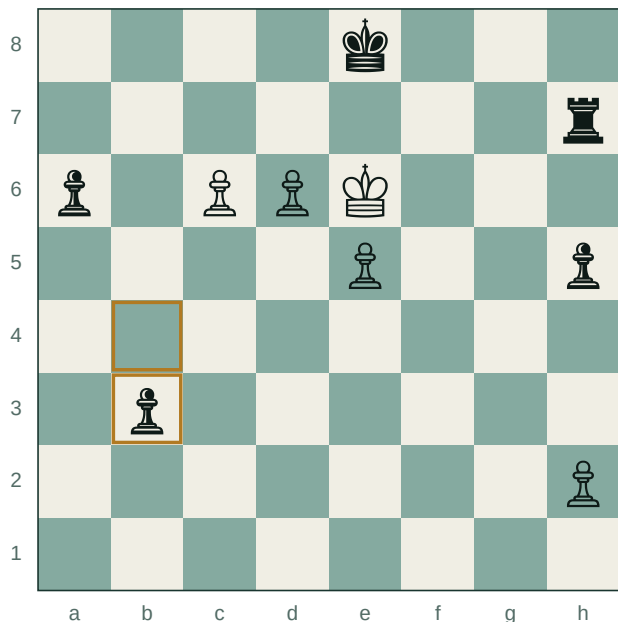


Active defensive resources: White, move 52

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 51...b3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52. d7+ Kd8 53. Kd6 Rh6+ 54. e6 Rxe6+ 55. Kxe6 Kc7 56. Ke7

52.d7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **52...Kd8**.

53.Kd6 The king moves from e6 to d6. Recorded reply: **53...Rh6+**.

54.e6 The pawn moves from e5 to e6. Recorded reply: **54...Rxe6+**.

55.Kxe6 The king captures the rook on e6. Recorded reply: **55...Kc7**.

56.Ke7 The king moves from e6 to e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h7. Check for tactical protection.